

Maria Silva

38, Marlborough Road, Maidenhead, Berkshire · +447935308070 · mariafgsilva10@gmail.com ·
linkedin.com/in/mariafgsilva10

LLB and LLM graduate with over a year of hands-on paralegal experience spanning commercial contracts, legal drafting, document review and case file management. At BCLP I supported complex, deadline-driven matters across international arbitration and real estate disputes, drafting procedural documents, reviewing evidence and managing large document sets under time pressure. At Adobe I reviewed and amended software licensing agreements, assessed contractual and data-protection risks and liaised with commercial stakeholders. Currently advising clients at Citizens Advice on a full range of legal matters, managing files independently from instruction to submission. Strong legal research and written communication skills; comfortable working at pace in a small team.

EDUCATION

Comparative and International Dispute Resolution LLM — Merit **Sept 2024 – Oct 2025**

Queen Mary University of London

- Modules in international arbitration, dispute resolution, procedural issues, legal research and evidence analysis
- Dissertation on data protection and the development of GDPR across jurisdictions — Distinction, 75%

Law LLB — 2:1

Sept 2020 – June 2024

University College London

- Modules including Advanced Contract Law, Commercial Law, Company Law and Alternative Dispute Resolution

International Foundation Programme in Law and International Relations

Sept 2019 – June 2020

King's College London

- Awarded the Leaders of Tomorrow prize (top 20 of a 200-student cohort; partial funding toward undergraduate degree)

EXPERIENCE

Adobe · London

June 2022 – Aug 2022

Legal Intern

- Reviewed and amended software licensing agreements; identified contractual risks and assessed alignment with internal legal and compliance requirements
- Reviewed confidentiality and data-processing provisions; researched UK GDPR, EU GDPR and cross-border personal data transfer requirements
- Liaised with sales, legal and international business teams to resolve contractual queries and reconcile commercial objectives with legal risk
- Supported acceptance of standard contractual terms: reviewed documentation, flagged provisions needing legal input and communicated agreed amendments to stakeholders
- Prepared and delivered an internal presentation on breach-of-contract risks and mitigation measures

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London

Aug 2023 – Feb 2024

Legal Placement Student — International Arbitration

- Drafted procedural orders and procedural histories; amended substantive sections of the Claimant's memorial in a complex investment arbitration
- Reviewed and organised large volumes of evidence for procedural submissions and the Claimant's memorial
- Became the primary junior supporting the team shortly before a significant submission deadline: coordinated documents, tracked outstanding actions and helped ensure on-time filing
- Maintained structured electronic case files and monitored procedural deadlines throughout the matter

- Liaised with the client on required documents; coordinated Romanian translations with an external translator
- Received feedback from a partner and associate that performance was comparable to that of a newly qualified solicitor

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London

Feb 2024 – Aug 2024

Legal Placement Student — Real Estate Disputes

- Prepared electronic hearing bundles and assisted with skeleton arguments and other court materials
- Conducted legal and factual research on rights of light, easements, leasehold issues and landlord and tenant disputes
- Managed large volumes of confidential documents across several concurrent matters with competing deadlines
- Assisted with court filings, hearing logistics, matter opening and closure, deadline tracking and cost comparisons
- Maintained matter records using iManage; prepared client notes and correspondence

Citizens Advice East Berkshire · Maidenhead

July 2026 – Present

Legal Adviser

- Manages a full caseload independently across welfare benefits, employment, housing, family, debt and consumer matters
- Takes detailed factual statements, establishes chronologies and identifies relevant legal and evidential issues
- Drafts correspondence, prepares applications and document schedules, and maintains confidential case records in compliance with deadlines
- Translates complex statutory and procedural requirements into clear, practical guidance for clients, including vulnerable individuals

Q-Legal · London

Oct 2024 – Jan 2025

Legal Adviser

- Managed a data-privacy matter from client instruction through to formal written advice letter, under a qualified solicitor's supervision
- Researched UK GDPR and Data Protection Act 2018 obligations for a data-driven start-up, including children's personal data and adtech
- Identified legal and compliance risks arising from the client's data processing activities and recommended practical mitigations
- Translated complex statutory requirements into clear, commercially focused written advice; coordinated with client and supervising solicitor to meet deadline

SKILLS

Languages: Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)

Technical skills: Legal and commercial research; documentary analysis; contract review and drafting; concise report writing; Microsoft Word, Excel and PowerPoint; iManage; legal research databases; electronic court filing portals; document review; electronic bundling; case management and time-recording systems

Case and evidence management: Evidence review, electronic hearing bundles, procedural histories, case-file organisation, deadline tracking across concurrent matters